

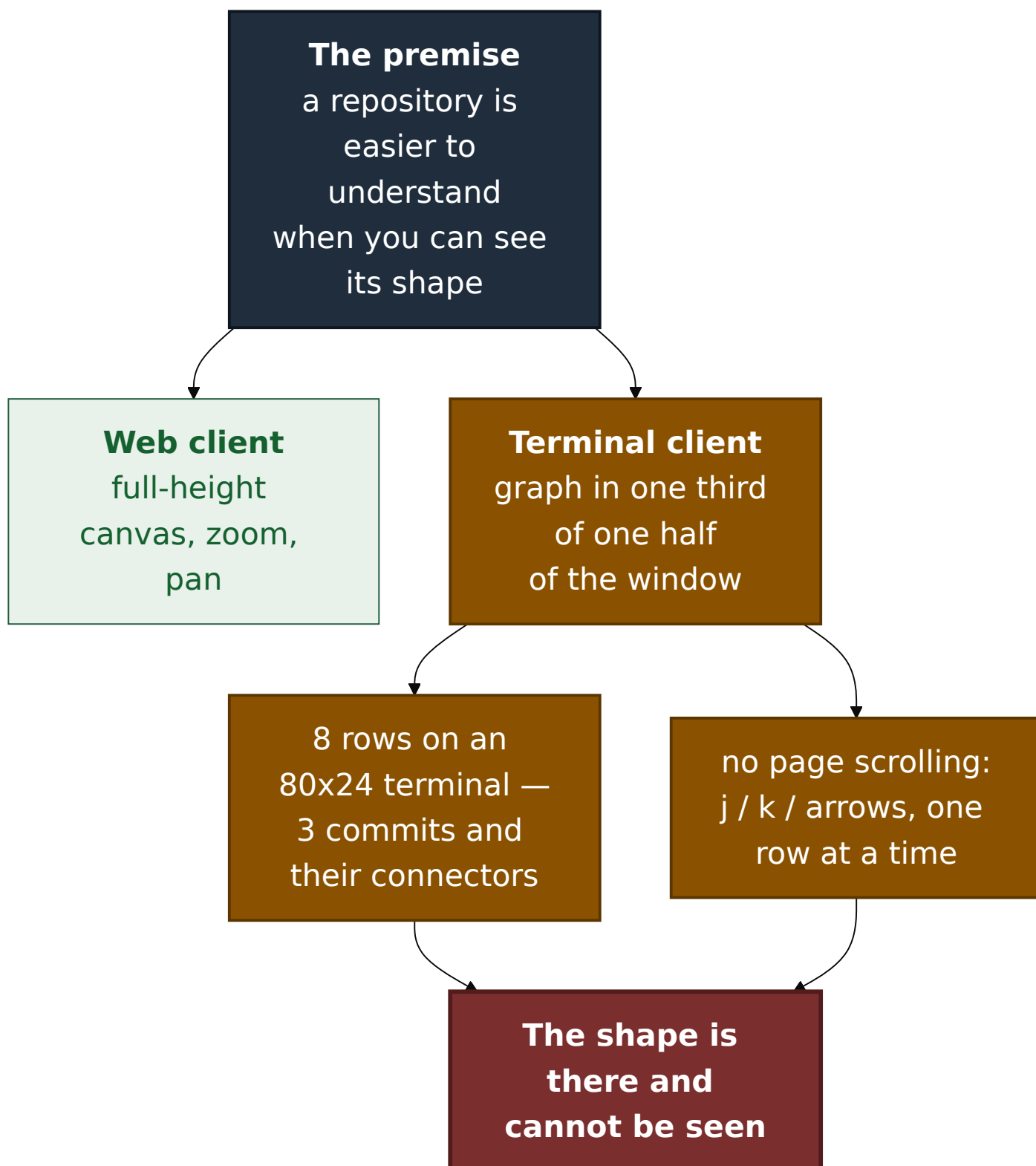
ADR 0109 — A page is what the frame just said it was, and zoom is why that matters

- **Status:** Accepted — implemented, mutation-proved two ways
- **Date:** 2026-09-03
- **Issue:** #625
- **Extends:** [ADR 0102](#), [ADR 0105](#)
- **Supersedes / superseded by:** —

Context

The premise of this project is that a repository is easier to understand when you can **see** its shape. The browser client got a full-height zoomable canvas for exactly that reason. The terminal client draws the same graph in the smallest pane on the screen, and until this issue there was no way to make it any bigger and no way to move through it faster than one row at a time.

M10 shipped that way and nobody noticed, which is worth saying plainly: every acceptance criterion in the milestone was about the **correctness of the content**, and not one was about **how much of the screen the content gets**. No test could have caught it. Nothing was broken.



The keyboard had room for the fix. `PageUp` , `PageDown` , `Home` and `End` appeared nowhere in the crate; no `maximize` , `zoom` or `fullscreen` identifier existed anywhere in it. The arrow keys, often the first suspect in a report like this, were already bound alongside `k / j` with a test pinning both spellings — so they were never the missing piece.

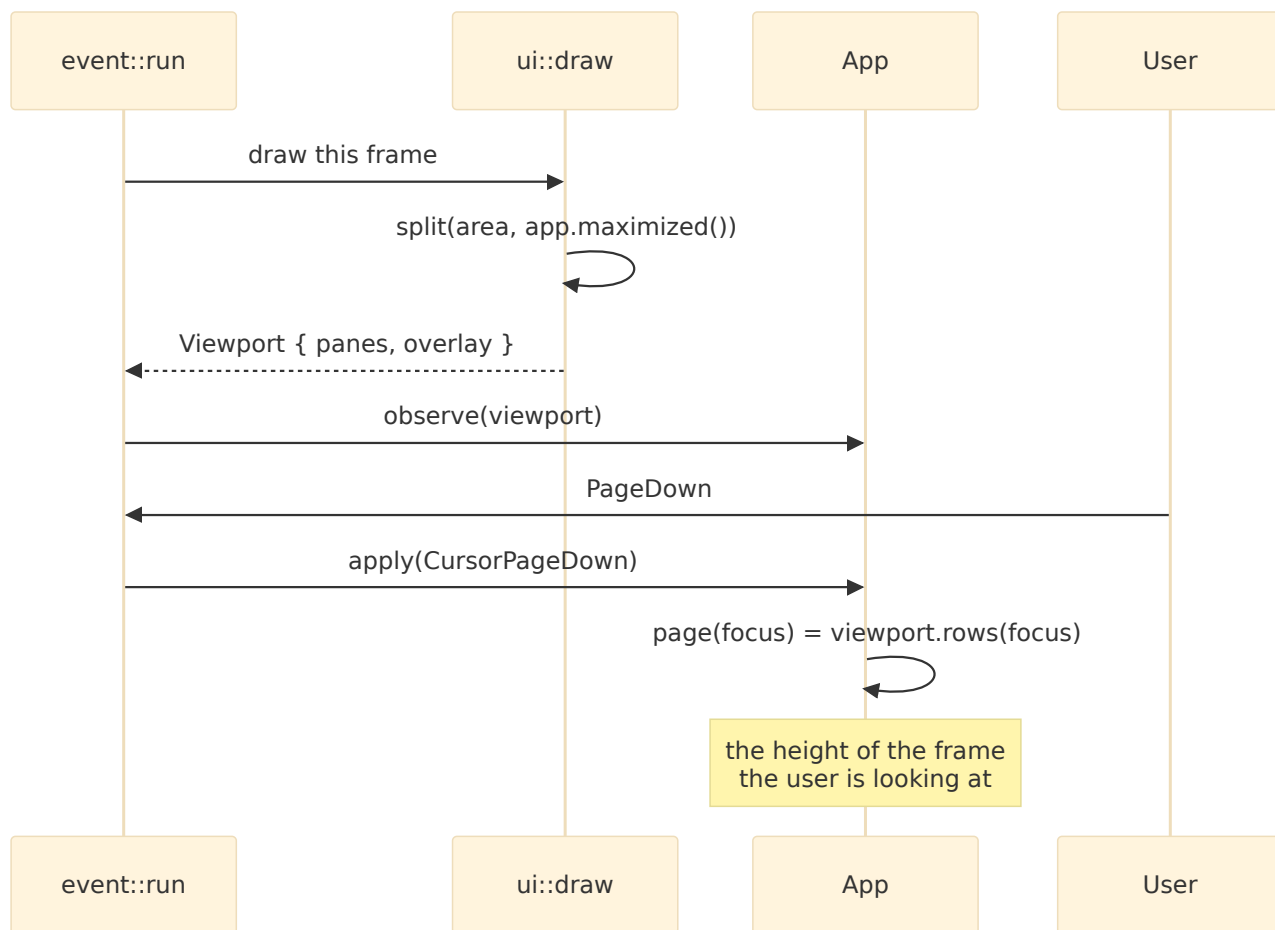
Decision

Four page keys and one zoom key, and — the part that is actually a decision — **the page size is measured from the frame that**

was just drawn.

1. Drawing is also measuring

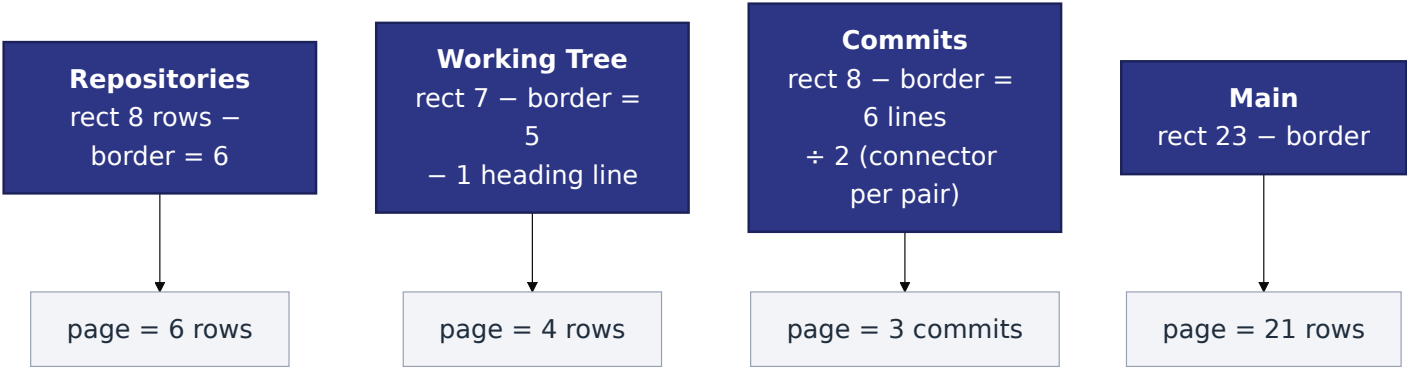
`ui::draw` now returns a `Viewport`: how many rows of its own content each surface had room for, taken from the very rects the widgets were rendered into. `event::run` hands it to `App::observe` immediately after the draw and before the next key is read.



The indirection is the whole point. The alternative — a constant, or a size computed once at startup — is right in a one-third-height pane and wrong the moment the zoom key hands that same pane the whole window. It would look correct in every small-pane test.

2. A page is in the units its cursor counts

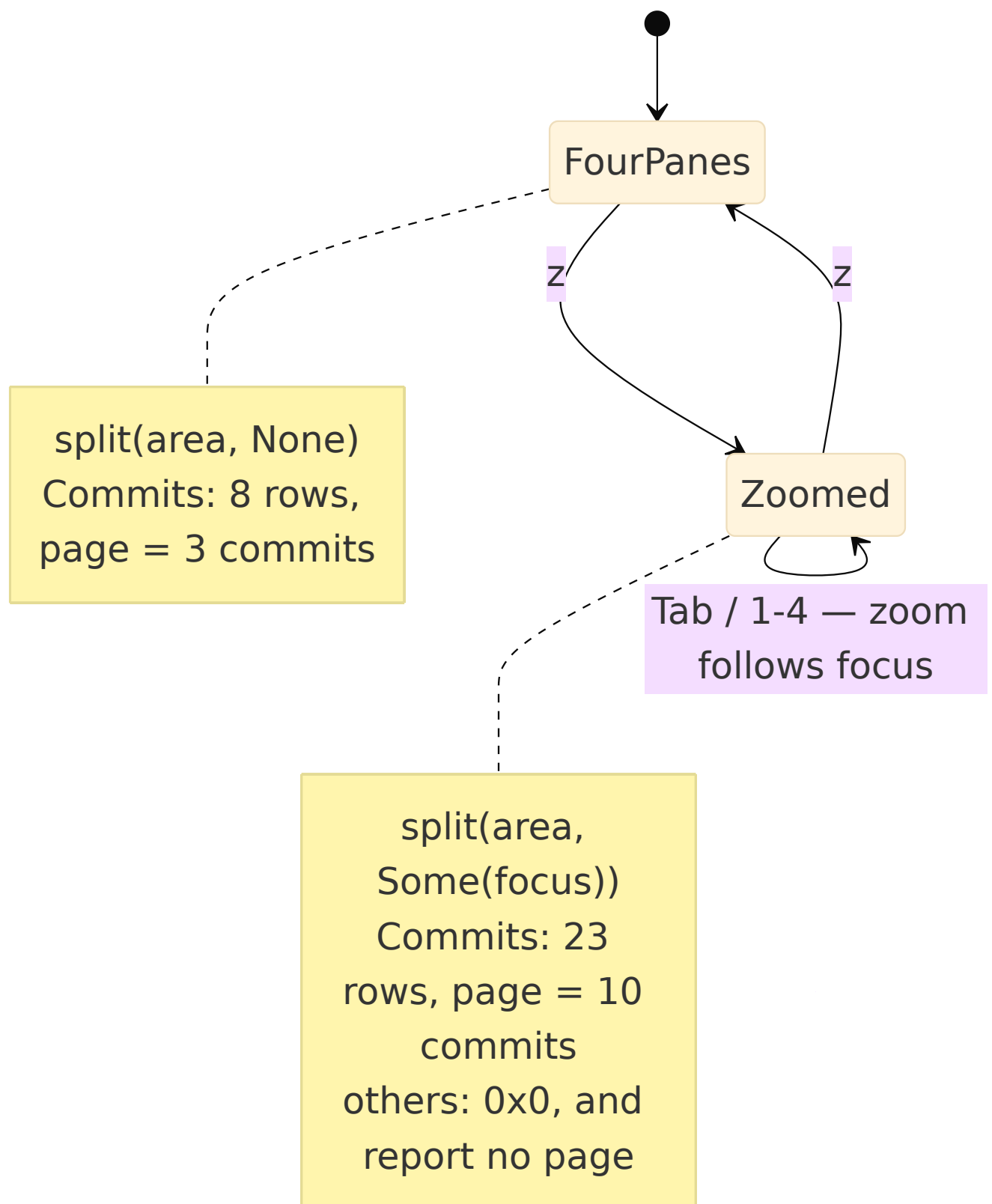
The graph draws a connector row between every pair of commits, so its cursor counts **commits** while its pane is measured in **lines**. Its viewport is therefore reported as `height / 2`. The working tree reports its list height minus the heading row, which is not a row its cursor can select.



A page in the wrong units is not a rounding error: `PageDown` on the graph would jump twice as far as a screen and skip half the history it claimed to page through.

3. Zoom is a maximize toggle on the focused pane

`z` gives the focused pane the whole body and puts the four-pane shape back. `layout::split` takes the zoomed pane; the other three come back as **zero-sized rects at the body's origin**, so the existing exact-tiling invariant covers both shapes rather than exempting the new one, and every drawing path stays a projection of a `Panes` instead of branching on a mode.

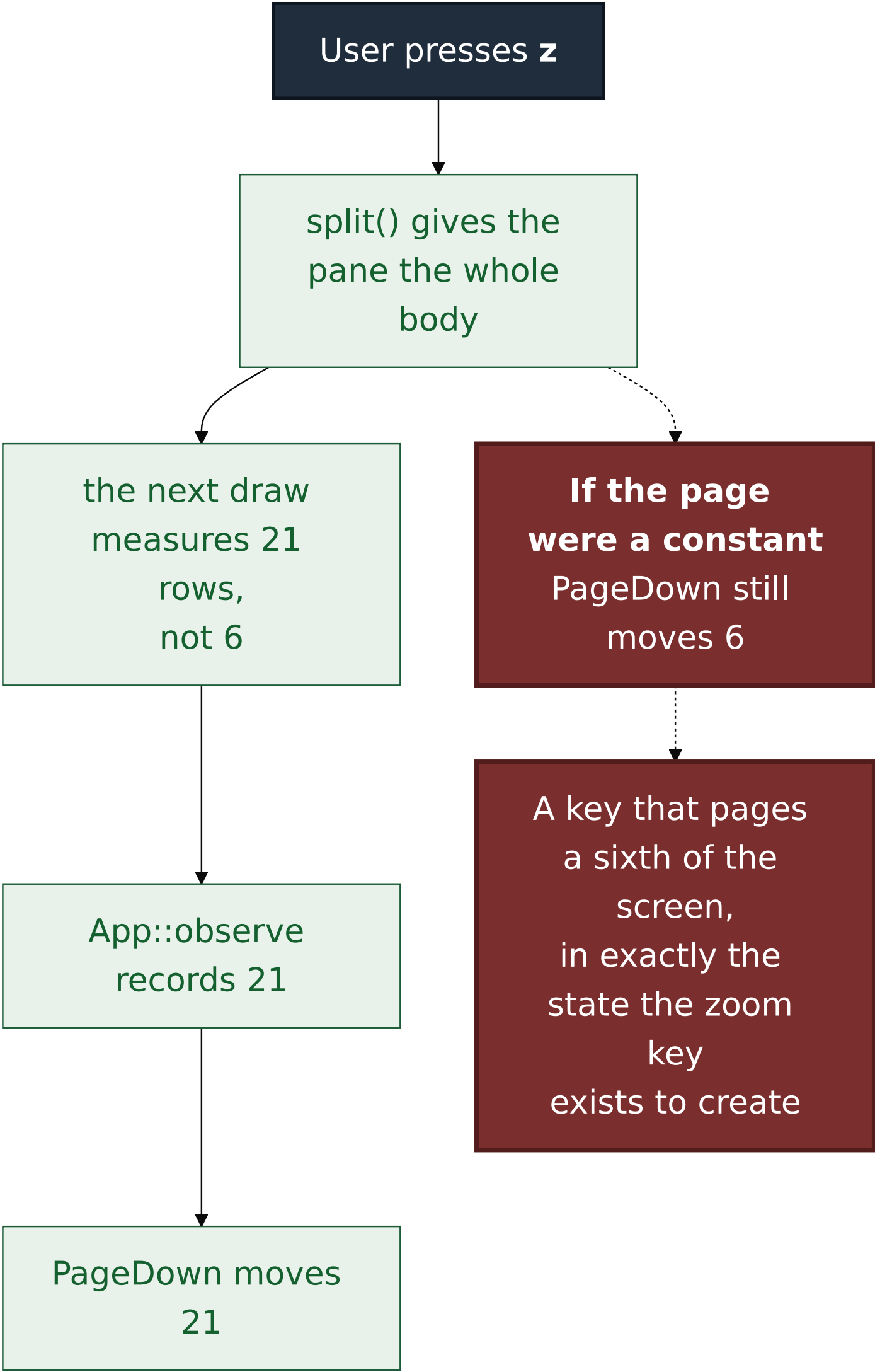


Zoom **follows focus** rather than pinning the pane it was pressed on: `z` then Tab shows the next pane full-height, which is what somebody wanting a big look at something else means, and it leaves no stale "zoomed pane" to reconcile when focus moves.

The status strip says `· z zoom`, and once zoomed says `· z unzoom`. It is appended by the renderer rather than written into

each of a dozen status sentences, because a binding nobody can discover is a binding nobody has.

4. The two halves interact, and that is the defect worth pinning



Alternatives considered

Mouse wheel capture — rejected, and the smaller fix is the better one

The issue originally proposed capturing the mouse. It was rejected on three independent grounds, recorded here so nobody re-adds it later believing it was an oversight:

- Mouse capture takes terminal **text selection** away in most terminals. Copying a commit hash out of a pane would stop working without a modifier.
- Capture must be torn down on **panic** as well as on exit, or a crash leaves the user's terminal swallowing their mouse.
- Wheel events would have to be routed to the pane under the **pointer**, not the focused one — a second, parallel notion of "which pane" for the rest of the program to keep consistent.

Four key bindings cost none of that, work over SSH and in every multiplexer, and follow the focus model that already exists.

A statically bigger graph pane — rejected

Trades one fixed layout for another, and costs the working-tree pane that #459 exists to show. The complaint is not that the graph should always be big; it is that it can never be big.

Resizable splits — rejected as premature

A layout engine with draggable dividers is a much larger change for a program with one user, and lazygit's single-key maximize is the convention this milestone is modelled on.

Recomputing the page size from the terminal size — rejected

`layout::split` could be called a second time from the event loop instead of having `draw` report what it drew. Two derivations of one geometry can disagree, and the one that would be believed is the

one nobody can see. The measurement now comes from the rects the widgets were actually rendered into, and each `draw_*` helper reports its own number, because the function that decided the geometry is the only one that can report it without guessing.

Consequences

- `PageUp`, `PageDown`, `Home` and `End` work in all four panes, in the plan review modal, and in the conflict overlay. In the overlay's **insert mode** they are deliberately unbound: that mode owns the keyboard outright, and a scroll under a live text caret is worse than an inert key.
- The conflict overlay's Inspect scroll is now clamped to its own row count instead of running past the end and being clamped again at draw time. Held unbounded, a page key would have built a scroll position hundreds of pages past the file, and the first `PageUp` after it would have appeared to do nothing.
- `layout::split` takes a second argument, so every call site states whether it wants the zoomed shape. The four-pane result is unchanged.
- `ui::draw` returns a value. Callers that only want the pixels must discard it explicitly.
- `z` is spent. The unbound-key test in `keys.rs` has now lost four members to real bindings across four slices, each caught by that test failing rather than by anyone remembering.
- A page is deliberately the **full** visible count, not height-minus-one. A pane squeezed to no interior still moves by one, so `PageDown` degrades to `j` rather than being silently inert.

Verification

`cargo test -p gv-tui --bins` — **177 passed, 0 failed** (`--bins`, never `--lib`: this crate's `lib.rs` is a stub and `--lib` reports 0 tests as a pass). The crate's integration test passes separately (1 passed). `cargo clippy -p gv-tui --all-targets -- -D warnings` and `cargo fmt --all -- --check` are clean.

Mutation matrix

`failure-atlas mutation_check` ran against committed HEAD `9bcd3827`, with the working tree reported clean. Both baselines were green (177 passed) and both mutated legs reached and failed assertions; no compiler failure is counted as a catch.

Invariant	Mutation	Result
A page is the pane's current visible height	remove: drop <code>app.observe(measured)</code> from the event loop, so the measurement never reaches the app	caught (record 183) — both end-to-end tests red; the page collapsed to the floor of 1
A page is the pane's current visible height	weaken: <code>page()</code> returns the constant <code>6</code> — the value that is <i>correct</i> at 80x24	caught (record 188) — 4 tests red

The second mutation is the one that matters, and its failure output is the proof that the two-height requirement is load-bearing: under a constant `6`, the **80x24** assertion still passed and only the **80x60** assertion failed (`left: 6, right: 18`). A single-height test could not have caught it. That is precisely the shape this ADR exists to prevent — a page size that is right in a small pane and wrong the moment somebody zooms one.

Two further invariants carry their own mutation notes in the source rather than a separate run: the zoomed-layout tiling invariant in `layout.rs` and the per-pane unit measurement in `ui.rs`.

Signed: max · 2026-09-03